

D282

Cloud Foundations

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A retail company runs 30 Amazon EC2 instances in us-east-1 under a three-year enterprise agreement. A critical security patch is released for the Linux operating system on those instances. Who is responsible for applying it?

- A. No one, since cloud servers are always secure
- B. AWS and the company split each patch equally
- C. The retail company
- D. AWS

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which task is AWS's responsibility under the shared responsibility model?

- A. Physical security of its data centers
- B. Setting IAM user permissions
- C. Choosing whether to encrypt customer data
- D. Writing security group rules

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A startup with five developers that just raised \$2 million wants to upload its web code and have the provider handle servers, operating systems, and runtime patching. Which service model fits?

- A. Platform as a Service (PaaS)
- B. On-premises hosting
- C. Software as a Service (SaaS)
- D. Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS)

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A firm uses a web-based email service that the vendor fully runs. What does the firm still manage?

- A. Nothing at all
- B. Operating system patching
- C. User accounts, access settings, and its own data
- D. The application code

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A hospital network with six facilities keeps patient records on servers in its own data center for regulatory reasons, while its appointment website runs on a public cloud and connects back to those records. Which deployment model is this?

- A. Public cloud
- B. Hybrid cloud
- C. Multi-cloud
- D. Private cloud

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A manufacturer whose fiscal year ends in June plans to replace a \$500,000 server refresh with cloud services. The CFO asks how this changes the company's spending. What is the best answer?

- A. It eliminates IT costs entirely.
- B. It turns the servers into a depreciating asset.
- C. It raises capital expense.
- D. It shifts spending from upfront capital expense to variable operating expense.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an example of capital expenditure?

- A. A monthly cloud storage bill
- B. Paying hourly for on-demand virtual machines
- C. A per-user SaaS subscription
- D. Buying server racks for the company's own data center

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

An online toy store founded in 2010 sees traffic jump tenfold on Black Friday and fall back the next week. It wants capacity to grow and shrink automatically with demand. What should it use?

- A. Resize to one larger instance
- B. A content delivery network only
- C. An Auto Scaling group
- D. Enough servers for peak load all year

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A scheduling app that books 8,000 clinic appointments a day must stay running if one AWS data center loses power. What design meets this?

- A. Serve the app from edge locations.
- B. Run several instances in one Availability Zone.
- C. Use one much larger instance.
- D. Run instances in at least two Availability Zones behind a load balancer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A contractor hired for three months at \$95 an hour needs to read files in one S3 bucket and nothing else. How should access be granted?

- A. Share the root account login.
- B. Create an IAM identity with a policy allowing only read actions on that bucket.
- C. Attach AdministratorAccess.
- D. Allow full S3 access to all buckets.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A credit union's core database, which stores 4 TB, runs 24 hours a day and will be needed for at least three more years. Which pricing option usually costs least?

- A. Reserved Instances or a Savings Plan
- B. Spot Instances
- C. On-Demand, because it is always the cheapest
- D. Dedicated Hosts

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A batch job renders images overnight and can be stopped and restarted at any time. Which pricing option usually costs least?

- A.** Dedicated Hosts
- B.** Spot Instances
- C.** On-Demand Instances
- D.** Reserved Instances

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	—	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A retail company runs 30 Amazon EC2 instances ~~in us-east-1 under a three-year enterprise agreement~~. A critical security patch is released for the Linux operating system on those instances. Who is responsible for applying it?

Target word: owner of guest OS patching **Decides:** Guest OS on EC2 is the customer's layer.

A	Absolute language	The customer still secures what it runs.
B	Adjacent category	Duties are divided by layer, not shared per task.
C	Correct	Customers manage the guest OS on IaaS.
D	Confusion set	AWS patches the host and hypervisor, not the guest OS.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

Which task is AWS's responsibility under the shared responsibility model?

Target word: provider-side task **Decides:** Security of the cloud.

A	Correct	Facilities are the provider's layer.
B	Inverted operation	Identity management is the customer's job.
C	Confusion set	AWS offers encryption; the customer decides to use it.
D	Adjacent category	Network configuration is the customer's job.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A startup ~~with five developers that just raised \$2 million~~ wants to upload its web code and have the provider handle servers, operating systems, and runtime patching. Which service model fits?

Target word: service model **Decides:** Customer manages only code and data.

A	Correct	The platform handles everything below the code.
B	Inverted operation	The company would manage everything.
C	Confusion set	SaaS is a finished application; you do not deploy your own code.
D	Adjacent category	The customer would still manage the OS.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

A firm uses a web-based email service that the vendor fully runs. What does the firm still manage?

Target word: customer duties in SaaS **Decides:** SaaS leaves users and data to the customer.

A	Absolute language	Identity and data always stay with the customer.
B	Inverted operation	That is IaaS, not SaaS.
C	Correct	Those remain the customer's duty in SaaS.
D	Adjacent category	That is PaaS.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A hospital network ~~with six facilities~~ keeps patient records on servers in its own data center for regulatory reasons, while its appointment website runs on a public cloud and connects back to those records. Which deployment model is this?

Target word: deployment model **Decides:** On-premises plus public cloud, connected.

A	Confusion set	Ignores the in-house records.
B	Correct	Combines on-premises and public cloud.
C	Adjacent category	Means using several public providers.
D	Dropped element	Ignores the public-cloud website.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A manufacturer ~~whose fiscal year ends in June~~ plans to replace a \$500,000 server refresh with cloud services. The CFO asks how this changes the company's spending. What is the best answer?

Target word: effect on spending type **Decides:** Pay-as-you-go replaces upfront purchase.

A	Absolute language	Usage fees and staff costs remain.
B	Confusion set	Depreciation applies to owned hardware, not cloud bills.
C	Inverted operation	Cloud reduces hardware purchases.
D	Correct	Cloud is billed by use.

7. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

Which is an example of capital expenditure?

Target word: pick CapEx **Decides:** Upfront purchase of a long-lived asset.

A	Inverted operation	Usage-based operating expense.
B	Confusion set	Operating expense.
C	Adjacent category	A recurring operating expense.
D	Correct	An upfront asset purchase.

8. Answer C Concept 5

An online toy store ~~founded in 2010~~ sees traffic jump tenfold on Black Friday and fall back the next week. It wants capacity to grow and shrink automatically with demand. What should it use?

Target word: elastic capacity **Decides:** Automatic grow and shrink.

A	Adjacent category	A one-time vertical scale, not elastic.
B	Confusion set	Caches content but does not add compute.
C	Correct	Adds and removes instances based on demand.
D	Inverted operation	Pays for idle capacity most of the year.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A scheduling app that books 8,000 clinic appointments a day must stay running if one AWS data center loses power. What design meets this?

Target word: high-availability design **Decides:** Survive one data center failing.

A	Confusion set	Edge locations cache content; they do not run the app.
B	Dropped element	All fail if that AZ fails.
C	Adjacent category	Size does not remove the single point of failure.
D	Correct	Each AZ is separate infrastructure.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A contractor hired for three months at \$95 an hour needs to read files in one S3 bucket and nothing else. How should access be granted?

Target word: least-privilege access **Decides:** Read-only on one bucket.

A	Inverted operation	The opposite of least privilege.
B	Correct	Grants just what is needed.
C	Adjacent category	Far more than needed.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out the one-bucket, read-only limits.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A credit union's core database, which stores 4 TB, runs 24 hours a day and will be needed for at least three more years. Which pricing option usually costs least?

Target word: pricing for steady use **Decides:** Steady, long-term, cannot be interrupted.

A	Correct	A commitment gives a large discount for steady use.
B	Confusion set	Can be interrupted; wrong for a core database.
C	Absolute language	Flexible but costs more for steady use.
D	Adjacent category	For licensing or isolation needs, not lowest cost.

12. Answer B Concept 8 • transfer

A batch job renders images overnight and can be stopped and restarted at any time. Which pricing option usually costs least?

Target word: pricing for interruptible work **Decides:** Interruptible and flexible.

A	Confusion set	Higher cost for physical isolation.
B	Correct	Deepest discount for work that tolerates interruption.
C	Adjacent category	Works, but costs more than Spot.
D	Inverted operation	Suited to steady, always-on use.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	11	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	0	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Shared responsibility model	The provider secures the cloud itself (facilities, hardware, hypervisor); the customer secures what it puts in the cloud (data, identities, guest OS, configuration).	Assuming the provider patches your EC2 operating system.	“Who is responsible for...” with IaaS resources.
2	IaaS, PaaS, SaaS	IaaS = you manage OS and up; PaaS = you manage code and data; SaaS = you manage only users and data.	Calling a managed code platform IaaS or SaaS.	What the customer does and does not have to manage.
3	Deployment models	Public = provider-owned shared cloud; private = dedicated to one organization; hybrid = on-premises or private linked with public cloud.	Calling a mix of on-premises and public cloud “private.”	Some workloads stay in-house while others move out.
4	CapEx vs. OpEx	Cloud shifts large upfront capital spending into variable, pay-as-you-go operating expense.	Believing cloud eliminates IT costs.	Buying hardware vs. a usage-based bill.
5	Elasticity	Elasticity automatically adds and removes resources to match demand, as with Auto Scaling.	Buying for peak load or resizing once and calling it elastic.	Demand spikes and then drops.
6	High availability with Availability Zones	Spreading resources across multiple Availability Zones in a Region survives the loss of one data center.	Running several instances in one AZ and calling it highly available.	“Keep running if a data center fails.”
7	IAM and least privilege	Grant each identity only the permissions it needs; never share or use the root account for daily work.	Giving broad access “to be safe” or sharing root credentials.	A new user who needs one narrow task.
8	Pricing models	On-Demand = flexible, no commitment; Reserved or Savings Plans = steady use with 1–3 year commitment at a discount; Spot = deepest discount for interruptible work.	Using Spot for workloads that cannot be interrupted.	How steady and how interruptible the workload is.

Course scope (public description): Cloud Foundations introduces learners to real-world issues and practical solutions to cloud computing. This course covers the business value of cloud computing, examining cloud types, the steps to successful cloud adoption, and the effect cloud adoption has on IT service management, as well as the risks and consequences of implementing cloud solutions. This course prepares learners for the AWS Certified Practitioner certification exam. There are no prerequisites for this course.